

NIRMAAN CLIMATEWORKS FOUNDATION

IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

Prepared by:	Vimala Telu, Senior Instructional Designer
Client:	Nirmaan ClimateWorks Foundation (NCF) — Bengaluru, India (Fictional)
Commissioned by:	GIZ India — Climate Finance for Cities (CFC) Program, Component 2
ADDIE Phase:	Implementation — Phase 4 of 5
Pilot States:	Maharashtra Tamil Nadu Karnataka Rajasthan Odisha
Target Participants:	200+ ULB Finance Officers across 40 Urban Local Bodies
Program Timeline:	March 2024 – February 2025 (12-month rollout)
Version:	V5.0 — March 2025 For NCF and GIZ India Review

1. Purpose and Scope

This Implementation Plan sets out the operational framework for deploying the Municipal Climate Finance Capacity Building Program (CF-101) across five pilot states in India. The program — a 40-hour blended learning intervention combining self-paced eLearning, live virtual workshops, scenario simulations, and a mentored Concept Note practicum — is designed to equip Urban Local Body (ULB) finance officials with the applied skills to access, structure, and deploy climate finance instruments for urban infrastructure and resilience projects.

The implementation operates at the intersection of three systems that do not always move at the same speed: the learning design and delivery system (NCF as implementing partner), the platform and technical system (National Urban Learning Platform — NULP), and the government partnership system (state Urban Development Departments and MoHUA). This plan anticipates and coordinates across all three.

Implementation spans four distinct phases: Pre-Launch Partnership and Platform Activation (Months 1–2), Cohort 0 Pilot (Months 3–4), Full Multi-State Rollout (Months 5–10), and Evaluation and Transition (Months 11–12). Each phase has defined outputs, owners, and decision gates. The plan is designed to be adaptive: findings from the Cohort 0 pilot explicitly feed into program adjustments before full rollout begins.

2. Program Overview

Program Element	Details
Learning Architecture	Self-paced eLearning (Rise 360) Virtual Workshops (Zoom) Scenario Simulation (Storyline 360) Mentored Concept Note Practicum
Total Duration	40 hours across 6 modules over a 12-week learning journey per cohort
Modules	M1: CF Landscape (6 hrs) M2: Green Bonds / SEBI 2023 (8 hrs) M3: MDB Instruments (6 hrs) M4: Blended Finance Workshop (6 hrs) M5: Carbon Finance for Cities (8 hrs) M6: Concept Note Practicum (6 hrs)
Platform	National Urban Learning Platform (NULP) — MoHUA-endorsed LMS with existing NCF MoU SCORM 1.2 Offline mobile download enabled
Language	English (primary). Bilingual support: Hindi, Marathi, and Tamil glossaries + dual-language key instruction screens embedded in all modules.
Assessment	Module quizzes (M1, M3): 10–12 items each, 70% pass threshold Concept Note Practicum (M6): 6-criterion rubric, mentor-assessed
Certification	Certificate of Completion issued via NULP upon: all module quizzes passed + Concept Note rubric score $\geq 65/100$ + Proposal Mentor sign-off
Cohort Model	State-based cohorts of approximately 40 participants each. Each cohort runs one 12-week learning journey. Rolling quarterly starts from Month 5 onwards.

Design Intent: Why Cohort-Based?

Municipal finance officials in Tier 2 and Tier 3 cities face significant isolation in their work on climate finance — they are often the only person in their organization trying to navigate MDB eligibility or SEBI green bond requirements. Cohort-based delivery, with peer learning built into the virtual workshops, creates a professional network among the participants that outlasts the program. Case study data from comparable GIZ and World Bank capacity-building programs consistently show that cohort-based

models produce significantly higher transfer rates than self-directed, individually paced programs in the same content domain.

3. State Partnership Activation

The program operates through state-level nodal structures. In each of the five pilot states, a State Nodal Officer (SNO) from the state Urban Development Department serves as the implementing liaison, identifying participant ULBs, validating participant lists, supporting scheduling, and tracking completion on behalf of the state government. State partnership activation is the critical prerequisite for the program: without it, participant identification, enrollment, and government credibility cannot proceed.

3.1 State Nodal Officer Responsibilities

- Identify and confirm 8 ULBs per state for participation in the program, in coordination with NCF and the state Urban Development Department
- Validate the list of Finance Officers and CFOs from each identified ULB (target: 2 participants per ULB, maximum 5)
- Provide institutional support for participant enrollment — issue formal participation letters from the state UD Department to each ULB
- Attend the State Partnership Orientation (Month 1) and the mid-program check-in (Month 6)
- Flag completion barriers and cultural or language-specific issues that affect participant engagement in their state
- Receive and review quarterly completion reports from NCF; escalate non-completion to ULB management where required

3.2 Partnership Timeline

Month	Activity	Output	Owner
1	State Partnership Orientation: NCF conducts a 2-hour virtual session with all five SNOs covering: program overview, participant identification criteria, enrollment process, SNO role and reporting	SNO commitment confirmed; MoU signed (where required); WhatsApp coordination group established per state	NCF Program Director
1-2	Participant identification: SNOs work with UD Departments to identify ULBs and individual participants meeting the criteria (Municipal Finance Officer / Deputy Commissioner Finance / CFO)	Validated participant list per state (minimum 35 per state); state UD endorsement letter per ULB	SNO + UD Department
2	Participant verification: NCF validates the list for role eligibility and confirms no duplicates across states	Final participant roster uploaded to NULP by NCF admin	NCF Program Coordinator
2	State communication: SNOs issue official participation letters to each ULB from their UD Department, instructing nominees to expect NULP enrollment	Official participation letters distributed to all 40 ULBs	SNO

4. Platform and Technical Setup — NULP

The National Urban Learning Platform (NULP) is MoHUA's endorsed digital learning platform for municipal capacity building. NCF has an existing Memorandum of Understanding with NULP for this program. The technical setup phase must be completed and tested before Cohort 0 pilot begins.

Setup Component	Specification / Requirement	Deadline
SCORM Package Upload	All six modules uploaded as SCORM 1.2 packages. Tracking: Completion status, quiz scores (item-level), time-on-task per module.	End of Month 2
Cross-Device Testing	Desktop: Chrome, Firefox, Edge. Mobile: Android (4G minimum), iOS (iPhone 12+). Low-bandwidth simulation test (equivalent to 2G) for rural/semi-urban participants.	Week 8
Offline Download	All Rise 360 modules configured for offline download via NULP mobile app. Participants in locations with intermittent connectivity can download and complete offline; data syncs on next connection.	Week 8
Bilingual Interface	Hindi and Marathi glossary panels embedded in M1, M2, M5. Tamil glossary in M1 and M5. All key instruction screens (navigation, quiz instructions, practicum guidance) available in English + Hindi toggle.	Week 8 (verified before Cohort 0)
Enrollment Configuration	Batch enrollment via participant roster CSV. Auto-enrollment confirmation email in English with NULP login credentials. Email includes: module 1 direct link, estimated time, offline access instructions, support contact.	Week 9 (Cohort 0)
Completion Dashboard	Automated weekly completion reports by state and cohort. Distribution: NCF Program Director + each SNO. Escalation report (< 25% completion by Week 6) generated automatically.	Configured before Cohort 0
Accessibility	WCAG 2.1 Level AA: closed captions on all video content, alt text on all images, keyboard navigable, high-contrast toggle. Screen reader tested on JAWS and VoiceOver before pilot.	Week 8
Technical Support	NULP helpdesk (existing). NCF Program Coordinator as first contact for program-specific queries. WhatsApp support group per state cohort (SNO + NCF Coordinator). Troubleshooting FAQ pinned to program page on NULP.	Before Cohort 0

5. Cohort Structure and Rollout Schedule

Participants are organized into state-based cohorts, each following a 12-week learning journey. Cohort 0 is the pilot cohort (20 participants drawn from across all five states), and its findings directly govern program adjustments before full rollout begins. State cohorts begin rolling from Month 5.

Cohort	State / Description	Approx. Participants	Start Month	End Month
C0 (Pilot)	Pan-state — 4 participants per state; mixed seniority; includes at least 2 mobile-only and 2 Hindi-medium participants	20	Month 3	Month 4
C1	Maharashtra — Nashik, Aurangabad, Nanded, Solapur, Latur (8 ULBs)	35–40	Month 5	Month 8
C2	Tamil Nadu — Madurai, Coimbatore, Salem, Tiruchirappalli (8 ULBs)	35–40	Month 5	Month 8
C3	Karnataka — Mysuru, Hubli-Dharwad, Mangaluru, Belagavi (8 ULBs)	35–40	Month 6	Month 9
C4	Rajasthan — Kota, Jodhpur, Bikaner, Ajmer (8 ULBs)	35–40	Month 7	Month 10
C5	Odisha — Bhubaneswar, Cuttack, Rourkela, Brahmapur (8 ULBs)	35–40	Month 8	Month 11
TOTAL	5 states, 40 ULBs	200+		

5.1 12-Week Learning Journey per Cohort

Week(s)	Activity	Description	Hours
1	Cohort Orientation + M1 Launch	30-minute virtual cohort orientation (Zoom): NCF Program Director introduces team, timeline, expectations. Participants activate NULP account. M1 (CF Landscape) self-paced module opens.	1+6
2-3	M2 — Municipal Green Bonds / SEBI 2023	Self-paced eLearning + Green Bond Readiness Checklist activity for own ULB. Participants complete checklist as input to M6 practicum	8
4	M3 — MDB Instruments	Self-paced eLearning. At end of Week 4: Module 1–3 knowledge check quizzes due. Participants who have not completed M1–M3 by end of Week 4 receive SNO support outreach.	6
5	Virtual Workshop 1 — Mid-Program Cohort Session	2-hour Zoom workshop: peer debrief of M1–M3 learning; Q&A with NCF climate finance practitioner; introduction to M4 Blended Finance Canvas; participants share their Green Bond Readiness Checklist findings in small breakout groups.	2
6-7	M4 — Blended Finance Models + M5 — Carbon Finance for Cities	M4 self-paced content (3 hrs) + Blended Finance Canvas activity. M5 self-paced eLearning + Kota W-t-E carbon finance simulation (Storyline 360). Participants begin identifying a project for M6 practicum.	14
8	Mentor Session 1 — Project Selection and Scoping	30-minute virtual meeting between participant (or pair from same ULB) and assigned Proposal Mentor. Project for Concept Note confirmed; instrument approach discussed; Mentor provides initial scoping guidance.	0.5
9-10	M6 — Concept Note Development (Self-Directed)	Participants draft their Climate Finance Concept Note using the NCF template. Asynchronous mentor feedback available via NULP messaging.	4

		Completion milestone: Section 1–3 of Concept Note submitted to mentor by end of Week 10.	
11	Mentor Session 2 — Concept Note Review	30-minute structured review session: mentor provides feedback against the 6-criterion rubric; participant revises based on feedback. Final Concept Note submitted to NULP by end of Week 11.	0.5
12	Virtual Workshop 2 — Cohort Completion Session	90-minute Zoom session: select participants present their Concept Note project (5-minute pitches, 3 per state cohort); NCF practitioner provides brief response; cohort debrief; survey completion; certification.	1.5
TOTAL			~40

6. Proposal Mentor Network: Onboarding and Management

The Proposal Mentor network is the most operationally complex component of the implementation. Forty mentors, climate finance practitioners with documented experience in green bonds, MDB engagement, blended finance, or carbon markets, are assigned to groups of 5 participants each across all cohorts. Mentor quality determines the quality of the Concept Notes produced, which are the primary Level 4 evidence of the program's impact.

6.1 Mentor Eligibility and Identification

- Minimum 5 years of demonstrated experience in at least one of: municipal green bonds, ADB/World Bank project development, blended finance structuring, urban carbon credits, or climate finance proposal writing
- At least one confirmed engagement with an Indian city or state government on climate finance in the past 3 years
- Availability for 8 hours per assigned cohort (2 × 30-min sessions per group of 5 + asynchronous feedback + cohort workshop participation)
- Sources: NCF practitioner network, GIZ CFC network, alumni of ADB India Urban Climate Finance program, NIUA-affiliated experts, ICLEI South Asia network

6.2 Mentor Onboarding

Component	Description	Timing
Mentor Orientation (2 hrs, Zoom)	Program overview; participant profile briefing; explanation of the Concept Note template and 6-criterion rubric; what good looks like at each criterion; how to give feedback that is actionable, not just evaluative; NULP messaging system walkthrough.	1 week before cohort starts
Rubric Calibration (1 hr)	All mentors for a given cohort review one sample Concept Note (NCF-prepared, not from a participant) and independently score it. Scores are compared; criteria with divergent scores are discussed and resolved. This calibration is mandatory before any mentor begins working with participants.	After orientation, before Week 8
Mentor Toolkit	Provided: Concept Note rubric (detailed, annotated) Sample mentor session agenda Feedback sentence starters (to model specific, constructive feedback) Common participant struggles guide NCF support contact for mentor escalation.	Distributed at orientation

Mid-Cohort Debrief	30-minute group call with all mentors from a given cohort at Week 10 (after first draft submissions). Share patterns: what are participants doing well? Where are they stuck? NCF uses this to add targeted support resources.	Week 10
Mentor Honorarium	₹8,000 per cohort (per group of 5 participants) paid upon submission of final rubric scores for all assigned participants. Payment processed within 15 days of cohort close.	After cohort completion

7. Virtual Workshops: Scheduling and Facilitation

Two live virtual workshops are embedded in each 12-week cohort journey. They serve different purposes: Workshop 1 is a knowledge consolidation and peer connection session held at the midpoint; Workshop 2 is a completion and showcase session at the end. Both require careful scheduling given that the target participants are government officials on varying office schedules across five states.

Workshop	Timing	Key Elements	Duration	Platform
Workshop 1 (Mid-Program)	Week 5	- Peer debrief of M1–M3 (breakout groups by state) - Q&A with NCF practitioner - Blended Finance Canvas introduction - Green Bond Readiness Checklist sharing - Module 4–6 preview and timeline check	2 hours	Zoom + NULP Breakout
Workshop 2 (Completion)	Week 12	- Cohort Concept Note pitches (3 participants × 5 min each) - NCF practitioner response and Q&A - Program reflection discussion - Survey completion in-session - Certificate ceremony (NULP digital certificate displayed on screen)	90 minutes	Zoom

7.1 Scheduling Protocol

- Workshops scheduled on Government of India working days (Monday–Friday, avoiding public holidays and key budget periods)
- Workshop 1 preferred timing: 11:00–13:00 IST — avoids morning meeting hours and pre-lunch shift changes in municipal offices
- Workshop 2 preferred timing: 15:00–16:30 IST — allows morning work hours and avoids end-of-day dropout
- Workshop invites sent 3 weeks in advance via email and NULP calendar, with 1-week and 1-day reminders
- All sessions recorded on Zoom (participant consent captured at enrollment). Recordings available to registered participants within 48 hours via NULP course page
- Minimum attendance target: 70% of cohort for Workshop 1; 80% for Workshop 2 (required for certificate eligibility)
- Participants who cannot attend either workshop may submit a written equivalent (300-word reflection for W1; recorded 5-min pitch for W2) — requires NCF Program Director approval

8. Learner Communication Plan

Municipal finance officials are busy professionals whose engagement with external training programs depends significantly on how communications are framed not as compliance obligations but as professional development opportunities with tangible career-relevant outputs. The communication plan is designed by the Chief Nodal Officer (NCF Program Director) and executed through a combination of state nodal officers, official email, and WhatsApp support groups.

#	Timing	Message and Purpose	Channel	Sender
1	Month 2	Program Announcement: Letter from GIZ India and NCF to each ULB Commissioner, cc'd to Finance Officer nominee. Explains program rationale (climate finance gap for Indian cities), what participation involves, and what participants will produce (a Climate Finance Concept Note for their city). Emphasizes the program is practical — not theoretical.	Official letter + Email	GIZ India + NCF Director
2	3 weeks before start	Participant Welcome: Personal email to each enrolled participant from NCF. Includes: confirmed start date, 12-week schedule at a glance, NULP account activation link, introduction to assigned Proposal Mentor. Tone: warm, practical, collegiate.	Email	NCF Program Coordinator
3	Week 1, Day 1	NULP Enrollment Activation: Auto-message from NULP with direct link to Module 1. Includes: offline download instructions, estimated time per module (6 hrs for M1), and a mobile app download link, if applicable.	NULP auto-email	NULP system
4	Week 3	WhatsApp Check-In: SNO sends a brief message in the state cohort WhatsApp group: "Hope M1 and M2 are going well. Any questions, tag the NCF team or me." Keeps the cohort visible and supported without adding administrative pressure.	WhatsApp group	State Nodal Officer
5	Week 5 (pre-Workshop 1)	Workshop 1 Reminder: Calendar invite with Zoom link + 1-paragraph brief on what to prepare (read the Blended Finance Case background note; bring your Green Bond Readiness Checklist findings).	Email + NULP	NCF Coordinator
6	Week 8 (pre-Mentor Session 1)	Mentor Introduction: Email introducing participant to their named Proposal Mentor. Includes Mentor bio (2 lines), Zoom link for Session 1, and the project scoping guide to review in advance.	Email	NCF Coordinator
7	Week 10 (post-draft)	Encouragement Message: NCF Director sends a brief note acknowledging that drafting a Concept Note is the hardest part and that the investment is worth it. Includes one sentence of encouragement specific to the cohort's particular state context.	Email	NCF Director

8	Week 12 (post-completion)	Completion Recognition: Certificate issued via NULP (auto). NCF Director sends personal congratulations email. GIZ CFC program sends a brief note acknowledging each completing ULB. SNO receives consolidated completion report for their state.	NULP + Email	NCF Director + GIZ India
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9. Multilingual and Accessibility Support

Support Area	Implementation Detail
Hindi Glossary	100-term bilingual glossary covering climate finance, green bond, and carbon markets vocabulary. Embedded as a collapsible panel in M1, M2, and M5. Each term: English Hindi transliteration Hindi definition (2 sentences max). Available as a standalone PDF download from the NULP course page.
Marathi Glossary	75-term glossary covering the most frequently used terms in M2 (SEBI Green Bond content). Developed by NCF Maharashtra network partner and quality-reviewed by two Marathi-speaking ULB Finance Officers from Nashik.
Tamil Glossary	75-term glossary. Developed by NCF Tamil Nadu partner organization. Quality-reviewed before Cohort 0 by Tamil Nadu SNO.
Dual-Language Navigation	All Rise 360 module navigation instructions, quiz instructions, and practicum guidance available in English and Hindi as a toggle. Default is English; Hindi toggle available in settings.
Workshop Language	Workshop 1 and Workshop 2 are facilitated in English. NCF provides a live Hindi-medium facilitation option for cohorts where the majority of participants indicate a preference. Tamil Nadu cohort workshops are offered with a Tamil-speaking NCF co-facilitator present.
Concept Note Template	NCF Concept Note template (M6 practicum) provided in English. Hindi-medium participants may submit their Concept Note in Hindi; NCF Program Coordinator provides translation summary for Proposal Mentor assessment. All rubric dimensions apply equally regardless of language of submission.
Low-Bandwidth Support	All modules tested at 2G equivalent speed. Rise 360 modules are image-optimized (all images < 200KB). Video content offered at 360p by default with 720p option. Offline download via NULP mobile app eliminates bandwidth dependency during module completion.

10. Evaluation Framework and GIZ M&E Integration

The program evaluation framework operates at two levels: the internal NCF evaluation (Kirkpatrick Levels 1–4) and the GIZ CFC program M&E system (which tracks capacity building outcomes as part of the broader CFC program results framework). Both are designed to be complementary, not duplicative. NCF provides data to GIZ; GIZ tracks aggregate program outputs.

Level	Metric	Collection Method and Timing	Target
L1 — Reaction	Satisfaction with content relevance, mentor quality, workshop facilitation, practical applicability	End-of-module surveys (M1, M3, M5): 5-item Likert + open comment. End-of-program survey: 12 items. Administered in-platform on NULP.	≥ 4.3 / 5.0 overall
L2 — Learning	Knowledge and skill gain: pre/post assessment scores; quiz performance; Concept Note quality	Pre-assessment (ungraded, Week 1) + Module quizzes (M1, M3) + Concept Note rubric scores. Pre/post comparison reported at cohort level.	≥ 35% improvement pre/post; ≥ 70% quiz pass rate; CN rubric ≥ 65/100

L3 — Behavior	Transfer to work: use of frameworks on the job; climate finance engagement activities undertaken	3-month follow-up survey to all completers (NCF sends, SNO supports response rate). 6-month follow-up survey. Questions: Have you applied a tool from the program? Have you initiated a climate finance inquiry?	≥ 60% report at least one framework applied within 6 months
L4 — Results	Climate finance proposals submitted; finance mobilized by participant ULBs	NCF Program Coordinator maintains proposal tracking register (ULB, instrument, stage, submission date). GIZ CFC program independently verifies via state UD Departments. Tracked for 18 months post-cohort completion.	≥ 8 ULBs submit formal proposal within 18 months

GIZ Reporting Integration

NCF submits a Quarterly Implementation Report to GIZ India CFC program management. The report covers: cohort completion rates, quiz performance data, Concept Note submission rates and quality summary, mentor feedback themes, and any program modifications made during the reporting period. The 18-month proposal tracking data feeds directly into the GIZ CFC Component 2 outcome indicator: "Number of ULBs with enhanced capacity to access climate finance." NCF is responsible for maintaining a dual-purpose data collection system (one that meets NCF's own internal evaluation standards and one that meets GIZ's reporting requirements) without creating duplicative burden for participants.

11. Risk Management

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Participant attrition: 40-hour commitment across 12 weeks leads to high drop-off, especially given competing ULB workload pressures	High	High	All modules in 20–30 min segments; offline download enabled; cohort WhatsApp group creates peer accountability; SNO personal outreach to participants at < 25% completion by Week 6; Module 6 practicum (Concept Note) creates a tangible deliverable that sustains motivation.
Regulatory content currency: SEBI, CCTS, or MDB instrument details change during 12-month rollout	Medium	High	Regulatory content held in modular 'policy update' screens that can be revised without rebuilding the full module. Mandatory content review at Month 6. NCF carbon policy team maintains a regulatory tracker that feeds into the update calendar.
Mentor quality variance: not all 40 mentors provide equally useful feedback; some participants receive poor-quality mentoring	Medium	High	Mandatory rubric calibration before each cohort; NCF Program Coordinator reviews all mentor session notes within 48 hours; participant satisfaction ratings for mentor collected at end of M6; mentors rated below 3.5/5.0 are not reassigned to future cohorts.

NULP technical issues: platform outages or SCORM compatibility failures during active cohort	Low	High	SCORM packages tested across all target devices before Cohort 0. NCF maintains offline-capable backup of all modules (HTML5 standalone) deployable within 48 hours if NULP is unavailable. NCF has an escalation contact within the NULP technical team.
State government disengagement: SNO changes role mid-program; new SNO is unfamiliar with program	Medium	Medium	All SNO commitments documented in writing at partnership orientation. NCF Program Coordinator maintains direct relationships with at least 2 contacts per state UD Department. SNO role is documented in a 2-page onboarding brief so that a new SNO can be oriented quickly.
Language access: Hindi/Tamil localization quality issues emerge from participant feedback during Cohort 0	Medium	Medium	Cohort 0 includes at least 2 Hindi-medium and 2 Tamil-medium participants specifically to surface localization issues before full rollout. Glossary quality review built into Cohort 0 evaluation plan. Native-speaker review contracted for both Hindi and Tamil content.

12. Go-Live Readiness Checklist: Cohort 0 Pilot

All items below must be confirmed complete before the Cohort 0 pilot begins. The NCF Program Director is responsible for signing off. Any item marked Not Ready triggers a hold on pilot launch until resolved.

Readiness Item	Owner	Status
All 6 SCORM modules uploaded and tested on NULP (desktop + Android mobile + iOS)	NCF Tech + NULP Admin	
Offline download confirmed working on low-bandwidth simulation (2G equivalent)	NCF Tech	
Hindi, Marathi, and Tamil glossaries embedded and toggling correctly in M1, M2, M5	NCF Content + NULP Admin	
NULP completion tracking confirmed: quiz scores, module status, time-on-task captured correctly	NULP Admin	
Weekly completion dashboard configured and tested (auto-distribution to NCF + SNOs confirmed)	NULP Admin	
Cohort 0 participant list confirmed (20 participants, 4 per state) and enrolled in NULP	NCF Coordinator	
NULP enrollment confirmation email tested (sends correctly, login credentials functional)	NULP Admin	

4 Cohort 0 Proposal Mentors confirmed, oriented, and rubric-calibrated	NCF Program Director	
Workshop 1 Zoom session scheduled (Week 5), invites sent to all 20 Cohort 0 participants	NCF Coordinator	
All 5 State Nodal Officers oriented (Partnership Orientation session completed)	NCF Program Director	
Cohort 0 WhatsApp support groups established (one per state, SNO + NCF Coordinator added)	NCF Coordinator + SNOs	
Welcome emails sent to all 20 Cohort 0 participants at least 3 working days before start	NCF Coordinator	
Pre-assessment (ungraded baseline) configured in NULP and set to auto-open on enrollment day	NULP Admin	
NCF Concept Note template and practicum guide uploaded to NULP resource page	NCF Content	
GIZ India CFC program officer briefed on Cohort 0 start date and evaluation data collection plan	NCF Program Director	
Formative evaluation instruments confirmed and ready (end-of-module surveys, pilot focus group guide, pilot debrief schedule)	NCF ID + Evaluator	